

Step-by-Step Setup Guide

From zero to a self-running client lifecycle — Notion + n8n + Claude — in about an hour.

You'll connect four pieces: a **Notion** workspace (your data), **n8n** (the automation engine), **Claude** (the AI that scores leads), and a **landing-page form** (where leads come in). Work top to bottom — each part builds on the last.

What you need: a Notion account, an n8n instance (cloud or self-hosted), an Anthropic API key with credits, and an SMTP mailbox for sending email.

Part 1 — Build the Notion workspace

1. **Duplicate the template (recommended):** open [the Notion template](#) and click **Duplicate** (top-right) to clone the full workspace — all five databases, views, relations, and the buttons — into your account. (Prefer to build by hand? Use the **Notion Business OS Blueprint** PDF.)
2. Open each database, and from the URL note its **database ID** — the 32-character hex string in the link (e.g. `app.notion.com/p/da223aa958fd45a8b76f9aae18c36de3?v=...`). You'll need the IDs for CRM, Projects, and Tasks.

Part 2 — Notion integration token & sharing

1. Go to `notion.so/my-integrations` → **New integration** → name it (e.g. "n8n") → copy the **Internal Integration Secret** (starts `ntn_`).
2. Share your databases with it: open the **Home** page → **...** → **Connections** → add your integration. Connecting at the Home page cascades to all five child databases. (If it doesn't, repeat on each database.)

This is the #1 gotcha. If a workflow returns `Could not find page...` make sure it's shared with your `integration`, the integration simply hasn't been added to that database yet.

Part 3 — Create credentials in n8n

In n8n → **Credentials** → **Add credential:**

Credential	Type	What to enter
Notion account	Notion API	Your <code>ntn_...</code> integration token
Anthropic account	Anthropic API	Your <code>sk-ant-...</code> key from console.anthropic.com
SMTP account	SMTP	Host, port, user, password, from-address

The lead-qualification workflow's HTTP node can also use a generic **Header Auth** credential — name `x-api-key`, value your `sk-ant-...` key — if you prefer not to use the native Anthropic node.

Part 4 — Import & configure the workflows

1. **Workflows → Import from File** → import each of the three JSONs from the `n8n-workflows/` folder.
2. In every Notion / SMTP / Anthropic node, attach the matching credential from Part 3.
3. Replace the placeholder database IDs with yours:

```
<<YOUR_CRM_DATABASE_ID>>    → your CRM database ID
<<YOUR_PROJECTS_DATABASE_ID>> → your Projects database ID
<<YOUR_TASKS_DATABASE_ID>>   → your Tasks database ID
```

(Open the relevant Notion "create" nodes and re-pick the database, or edit the ID directly.)

4. Toggle each workflow **Active**. Your production webhook URLs are then:

```
POST https://YOUR-N8N-HOST/webhook/lead-intake    (lead qualification)
POST https://YOUR-N8N-HOST/webhook/onboard-client (onboarding)
POST https://YOUR-N8N-HOST/webhook/offboard-client (offboarding)
```

Part 5 — Add the CRM buttons

Notion buttons are UI-only. In the **CRM** database, **⋮ → Properties → + New property → Button**, twice:

Button	Action	Send these properties
Onboard Client	Send webhook → <code>.../webhook/onboard-client</code>	Company, Name, Email, Project Type
Offboard Client	Send webhook → <code>.../webhook/offboard-client</code>	Company, Name, Email, Projects

Duplicated the template? The two buttons already exist — just edit each one and repoint its **Send webhook** URL at *your* n8n host. Notion's "Send webhook" sends its own payload (the page ID is included automatically) — the workflows' first node already parses it. "Send webhook" requires a paid Notion plan; on Free, use the button's **Open page or URL** action with the IDs as query params and switch the webhook node to GET.

Part 6 — Wire the landing-page form

In your site's `index.html`, point the contact form at the lead-intake webhook:

```
const N8N_WEBHOOK_URL = "https://YOUR-N8N-HOST/webhook/lead-intake";

function handleSubmit(e) {
  e.preventDefault();
  const payload = {
    name: document.getElementById('name').value,
    email: document.getElementById('email').value,
    company: document.getElementById('company').value,
    biztype: document.getElementById('biztype').value,
    bottleneck: document.getElementById('bottleneck').value
  };
  // show success immediately – never block the UI
  document.getElementById('contactForm').style.display = 'none';
  document.getElementById('successMsg').style.display = 'block';
  try { fetch(N8N_WEBHOOK_URL, { method:'POST',
    headers:{'Content-Type':'application/json'}, body:JSON.stringify(payload)
  }).catch(()=>{}); } catch (err) {}
}
```

Field IDs must match: `name`, `email`, `company`, `biztype`, `bottleneck`. The try/catch guarantees the success message shows even if the network hiccups.

Part 7 — Test each flow

- **Lead qualification:** submit the form (or `curl` the lead-intake URL). A scored lead should appear in CRM within seconds, with an AI summary.
- **Onboarding:** add a throwaway CRM row, click **Onboard Client**. Status flips to ● Client, a linked project appears, a welcome email sends, two tasks are created.
- **Offboarding:** on a client row with a linked project, click **Offboard Client**. Client → ★ Alumni, project → ✓ Complete + Offboarded, wrap-up email + two closeout tasks.

Delete any test rows when you're done.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
"Could not find page... shared with your integration"	Add the integration to the database (Part 2).
"Credit balance too low" on the AI node	Add credits at console.anthropic.com → Plans & Billing.
Select value error on a Notion write	The option text must match exactly, emoji included. Re-check the property's options.

Button seems to do nothing	Confirm the workflow is Active (buttons hit the production URL), then refresh Notion after a few seconds.
Form on the site does nothing	It always shows success by design; check the n8n Executions tab to confirm the webhook fired.